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EASE OF LIVING A view of Manasum senior living in Bengaluru

Director and Head of Research at Colliers India.

According to Nadar, cities like Coimbatore, Puducherry, Dehradun, Vadodara and spiritual hubs such as Tirupati, Vrindavan, and Ayodhya are likely to gain traction.

Badruka believes that for senior living, “the ideal location is connected rather than central—close enough to hospitals, the city and airport, but with sufficient space and greenery to create a high-quality living environment”.

The operators are following the seniors into these markets. Ashiana Housing, which is currently present in Delhi-NCR, Jaipur, Pune, Mumbai and Chennai, is now looking at entering

Bengaluru and Hyderabad.

Manasum is graduating from Bangalore and Goa to Mysore, Tirupati and Ahmedabad (GIFT city), as also Gurugram, Kolkata, Cochin, Lucknow and Chennai.

CHALLENGES

Industry players say the sector also needs greater policy coherence. India has multiple policies and schemes addressing different aspects of ageing, but the framework remains fragmented, says Raja Gopal of ASLI.

He adds that access to long-term institutional capital, rational taxation, stronger insurance coverage and a larger professionally trained caregiving workforce

are required to hold the multiple policies and schemes together in a framework.

Nadar of Colliers recommends broader government support, innovative financial solutions, public-private partnerships and incorporation of advanced construction technologies to help improve affordability and expand access.

The future is about building a continuum of living and care around the elderly, rather than viewing housing and healthcare in isolation.

As Narahari puts it, “Senior living ultimately needs the discipline of a hotel, the reliability of a hospital and the warmth of a home.” **BT**